

Storm Damage & Insurance Checklist

A step-by-step guide to documenting residential roof conditions before initiating a regional insurance claim.

SAFETY WARNING: Never walk directly on a damaged or wet roof. Conduct all inspections from ground level, balconies, or windows.

1 PHASE 1: IMMEDIATE GROUND INSPECTION

- ☐ **CHECK THE DOWNSPOUTS**
Inspect base grading zones where metal gutters discharge. Scan for dense piles of loose asphalt shingle granules.
PHOTO REQUIRED: Close-up of loose granules piled at the downspout exit.
- ☐ **INSPECT EXTERIOR SIDING AND TRIM**
Scan window metallic wraps, vinyl cladding, and garage doors for fresh wind dents, splitting, or debris impact scars.
PHOTO REQUIRED: Wide shot of dented framing, plus a close-up alongside a coin for physical scale.
- ☐ **SCAN FOR MISSING SHINGLE TEETH**
Observe roof valleys from lawn positions. Identify dark backing underlayment showing exposed deck profiles.
PHOTO REQUIRED: High-zoom focus snapshot pinpointing detached shingle slots.

Next step: call us at (443) 624-7508 or book a free inspection at arndtconstructionmd.com

We meet your adjuster on the roof and supplement the scope when damage is missed.

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2 PHASE 2: INTERIOR ATTIC & CEILING AUDIT

- ☐ **THE DAYLIGHT BEAM CHECK**
Enter the attic during full peak brightness hours. Keep panels dark and trace wood patterns upward.
PHOTO REQUIRED: Image capturing exterior light pinpricks shining through roof timber panels.
- ☐ **INSPECT UNDERLYING STRUCTURAL RAFTERS**
Guide your flashlight directly across main support rafters. Inspect lumber for damp tracking, active wet beads, or mold spores.
PHOTO REQUIRED: Sharp photo logging water trace marks tracking down support rafters.
- ☐ **TRACK INTERIOR WALL-TO-CEILING PLASTER**
Trace top sheetrock joints near second-story frame levels. Spot swelling paint, texturing separations, or dark moisture stains.
PHOTO REQUIRED: Close-up of internal wall moisture tracks or blistering drywall paint.

3 PHASE 3: ADJUSTER CASE RECORD

- ☐ **RECORD THE STORM EVENT DETAILS**
Write down the exact date, time, and type of weather event. Pull the NOAA or local news report confirming wind speeds, hail size, or gust duration in your zip code.
PHOTO REQUIRED: Screenshot of the NOAA Storm Events Database entry for your county on the event date.
- ☐ **PULL YOUR HOMEOWNER POLICY AND DEDUCTIBLE**
Locate your declarations page. Note your deductible, wind/hail deductible (often higher and separate), and the claims-reporting window required by your carrier.
PHOTO REQUIRED: Photo of the policy declarations page and the wind/hail deductible section.
- ☐ **LOG ESTIMATES, CALLS, AND ADJUSTER VISITS**
Start a single-page timeline. Every call, every emailed estimate, every adjuster visit date — written in one place. Wins supplements when scope disputes happen.
PHOTO REQUIRED: Photograph of the running claim timeline before each adjuster visit.

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